

POL101-20: From Politics to Political Authority (Summer 2026)

1. Introduction to Political Science, Summer 2026.
2. Topic arc: Heywood, Sartori, and classical political thought.
3. Focus: definitions, boundaries, authority, consent, and ruling.
4. Guiding question: Why do human beings need politics?

Three Core Objectives

1. Define politics through Heywood's four approaches.
2. Use Sartori to ask where politics begins and where it ends.
3. Connect five classical thinkers to authority, order, consent, and public life.

Course Arc from the Syllabus

1. Session 1: what is politics and how is political science a science?
2. Session 2: Sartori and Heywood on terms and concepts.
3. Session 3: Aristotle on family, polis, nature, and politics.
4. Sessions 4-5: Hobbes, Ibn Khaldun, Locke, and Rousseau on authority and social contract.

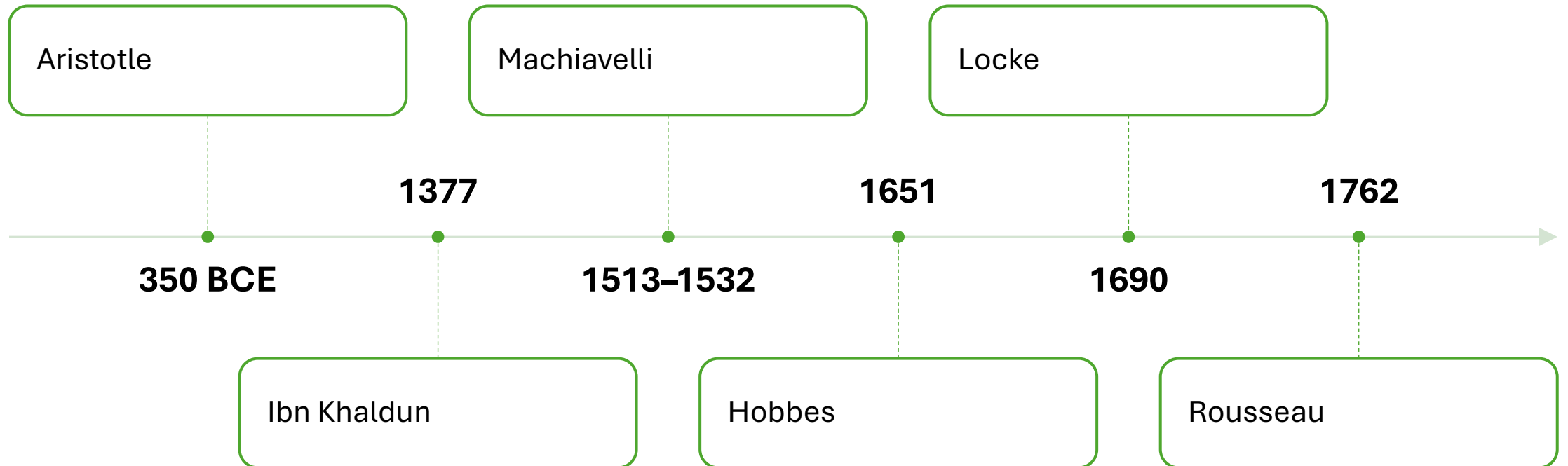
Why Begin with Heywood and Sartori?

1. Heywood gives a map of politics: arena and process.
2. Sartori gives a boundary problem: politics cannot mean everything.
3. The classical thinkers give answers to the same core question.
4. The lecture moves from definition to authority, then to consent and legitimacy.

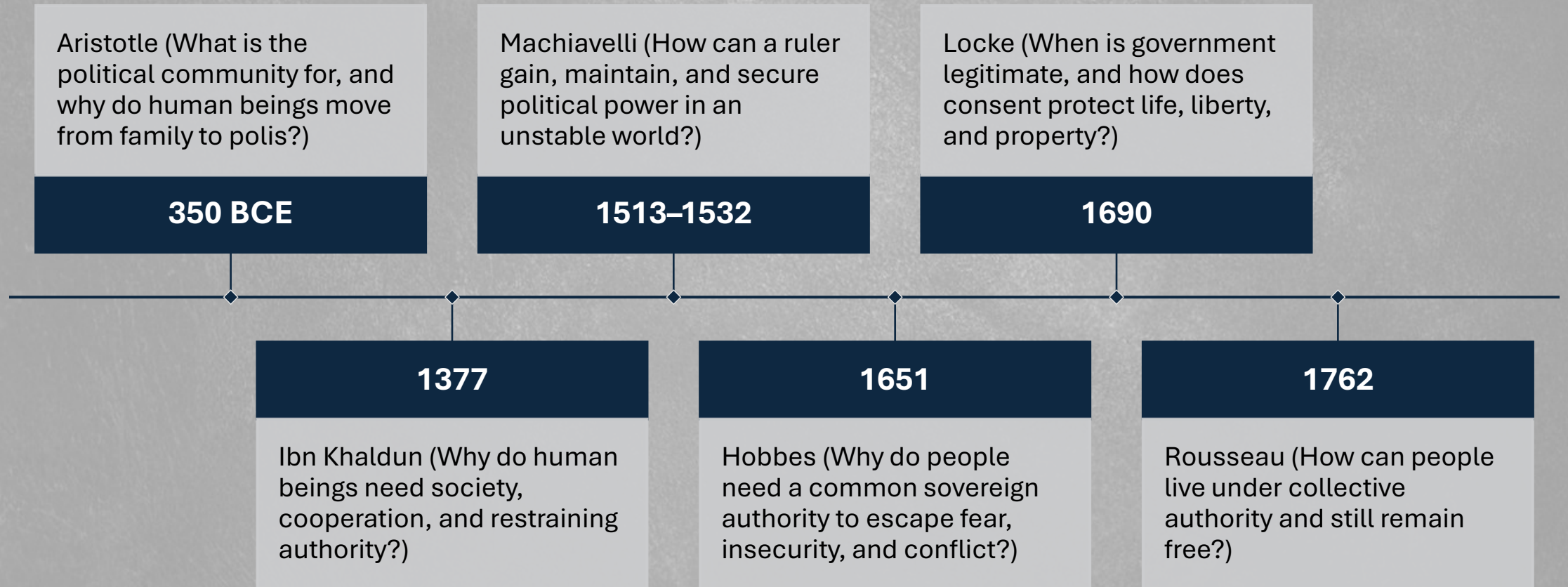
The Guiding Question

1. What makes a human problem political?
2. Is politics rooted in natural community, fear, cooperation, consent, or power?
3. When does authority become necessary?
4. When does authority become legitimate?

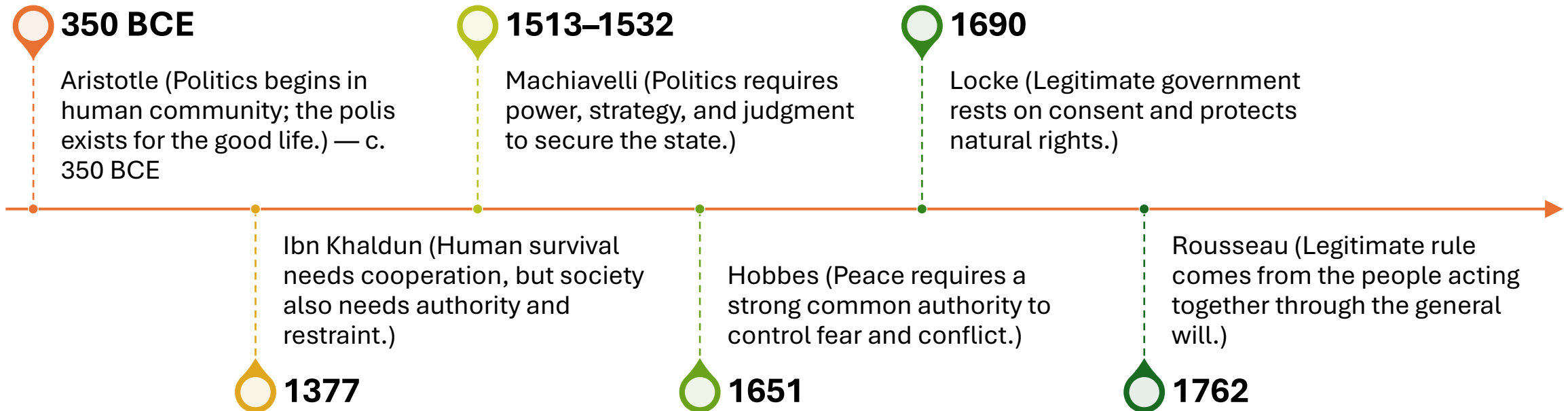
Historical Timeline



The Core Focus



Classical Thoughts



Heywood's Working Definition (Let's Revisit!)

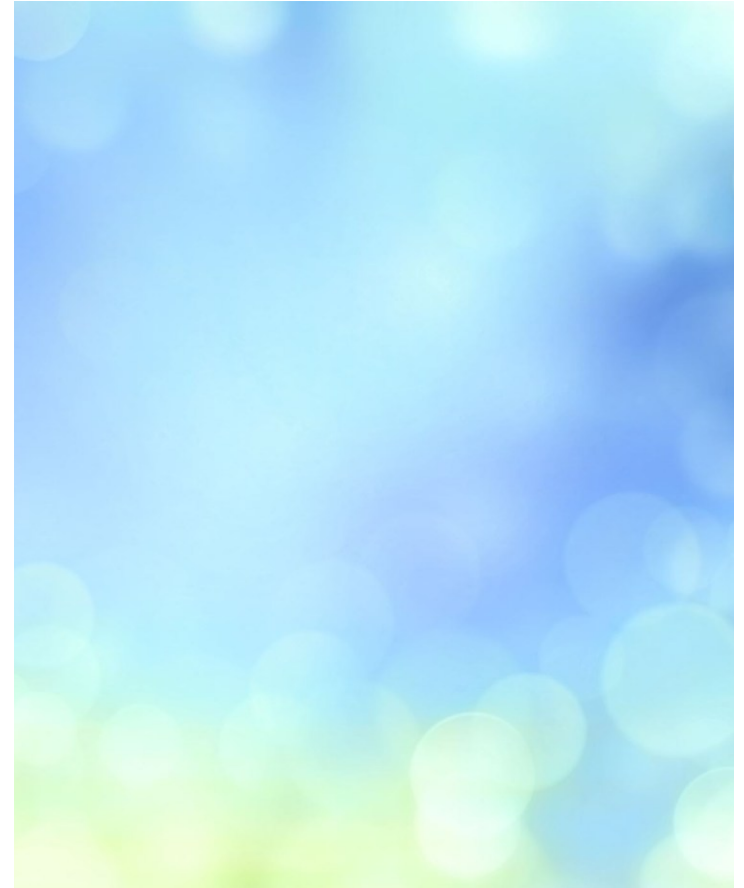
1. Politics is about making, preserving, and changing general rules.
2. Politics contains conflict because people disagree.
3. Politics requires cooperation because people must live together.
4. Politics is not only elections; it is the organization of common life.

How Context Shapes Theory

1. Aristotle writes from the world of the city-state.
2. Hobbes writes under the shadow of civil conflict.
3. Locke writes for limited government and rights.
4. Rousseau writes against domination and for collective self-rule.

Sartori's Main Focus

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1. Political science depends on the meaning of science and politics.
 2. If politics applies to everything, it applies to nothing in particular.
 3. Politics must be located in relation to society, economy, law, ethics, and religion.
 4. The task is not to reduce politics, but to define it carefully.



Sartori's Boundary Test



1. Where is the political site?



2. Who has authority to decide?



3. Is the decision public and binding?



4. Can the decision be escaped easily,
or does it structure common life?

Aristotle — Community and Good Life

Politics begins from human association: household, village, polis.

The polis exists not only for survival, but for the good life.

Political life depends on speech, judgment, and shared ideas of justice.

Let's reflect

- Sartori warns that Aristotle's political animal is not the same as modern state politics.



Ibn Khaldun — Cooperation and Authority

Human beings need cooperation for survival, livelihood, and defense.

Cooperation creates social organization and civilization.

Society needs restraining authority because conflict and injustice can break order.



Machiavelli — Power and Statecraft

Politics has its own practical logic, shaped by power and necessity.

A ruler must understand fortune, strategy, fear, loyalty, and timing.

The central political task is to secure the state in an unstable world.



Hobbes — Security and Sovereignty

Without common authority, fear and insecurity can push people into conflict.

Peace requires a power strong enough to enforce rules.

The sovereign exists to create order, protection, and common security.



Locke — Consent and Rights

People have natural rights: life, liberty, and property.

Government is legitimate only when based on consent.

Authority is limited: government must protect rights, not destroy them.



Rousseau — Freedom and General Will

Legitimate authority
must come from the
people as a
collective body.

The social contract
turns private
individuals into
citizens.

True freedom means
obeying laws one
helps create through
the general will.



How They Speak to Each Other

1. **Aristotle** begins with community: politics asks how humans live well together.
 2. **Ibn Khaldun** adds necessity: society needs cooperation and authority to survive.
 3. **Machiavelli** shifts to power: political order must be secured in real conditions.
 4. **Hobbes** makes security central: peace needs sovereign authority.
 5. **Locke** limits authority: government must rest on consent and protect rights.
 6. **Rousseau** emphasizes consent: people must rule collectively to remain free.
 7. Together, they move from community → authority → power → security → rights → freedom.
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